

Showcasing (showing off?) your treasures

Some collectors are secretive about their collections, while others love to flaunt it. One visit to the GD Naidu Car Museum in Coimbatore, and you will instantly understand what I mean. The flair with which the vintage cars are displayed resonates the pride of the collector. So, if you have collected a couple of good NFTs and want to display them, where would you and how would you?

- You can print, frame, and hang the NFT on a cosy wall in your house, if the contract permits.
- You can display the NFTs in digital marketplaces.
- You could download and install an app like token.art that lets you view NFTs easily on your phone. Most wallet apps also let you do that.
- If you own some space on the metaverse in virtual worlds like Decentraland or Cryptovoxels, you can display your NFTs there.
- You can use software platforms like Samsung Smartthings or Tokencast to download NFTs from your wallet and view them on state-of-the-art televisions.
- However, if you have a good collection, the best option might be to invest in a suave and smart NFT display with direct wallet integration, like Net-gear's Mural, Lago's NFT Frame, Blockframe, or Tokenframe.

celebrities. Last year, Visa purchased a CryptoPunk avatar for \$150,000, and Adidas purchased an Adidas-clad ape named Indigo Herz from BAYC, which is one of the key collaborators in Adidas' NFT projects.

You can get membership to the BAYC by purchasing one of 10,000 ape profile picture NFTs, which cost at least \$200,000 each. The membership gives you access to exclusive features, product drops, and events too. It allows users to mint art for the group. It gives IP control to the community, thereby having an unending source of fresh ideas. Primary and secondary resell rights ensure that the artists get paid for their efforts.

In-game assets

NFTs enable you to own characters or items on gaming platforms and virtual worlds. In-game assets come in many forms—ranging from creatures in Axie Infinity and trading cards in Gods Unchained to virtual real estate in Decentraland. Gaming platforms often use tokens to reward players. In the play-to-earn model followed by platforms like Axie Infinity, you

earn NFT rewards within the game, which you can monetise by selling in secondary markets.

With gaming platforms growing in scale to become virtual worlds with thriving marketplaces, real-world brands are also entering the space and selling their wares. You can, for example, buy virtual sneakers from Nike or Adidas for your avatar to wear in the virtual world.

The trend is advancing towards interoperable NFTs that enable cross-platform playability. You can take your NFTs along with you to other platforms to create personalised experiences or for trading. The Enjin generic axe is one such gaming NFT that you can take along to multiple platforms!

"NFTs are a standard protocol, so they can be traded across NFT marketplaces as long as the wallet holding the tokens is compatible and on the same blockchain network. So, anyone buying an NFT from one platform can resell it on another platform by connecting their wallet and having the smart contract listed in that platform. Cross-chain compatibility (cross-chain bridge) has recently been established across a few chains for

NFTs but has also been a source of vulnerabilities and hacks," says Menon.

With the advent of currencies and assets, gaming platforms are coming under the influence of market forces much to the displeasure of traditional game developers. According to the Game Developer's Conference 2022 Annual Report, 70% of the developers surveyed said their studios were not interested in integrating NFTs or cryptocurrencies in their games.

Nascent real-world applications

NFTs have the potential to transform several real-world processes. Experiments are underway but it will probably take time to become mainstream, because of the high costs and energy-related issues surrounding NFT usage. Nevertheless, let us take a look at some of the most promising applications:

IDs, certificates, and other documents: NFTs being immutable can result in accurate record-keeping with no risk of tampering. An NFT birth certificate can serve as a lifelong ID on the blockchain. Other medical records can be appended to the same, with complete trust and confidentiality. Some graduate schools like Emlyon in France are planning to issue NFT based diploma certificates to avoid certificate related frauds. Going forward, other important documents like passports, driving licenses, and other documents can also be encoded in the blockchain. This would help iron out kinks in several administrative processes ranging from public distribution to voting.

Real estate: In the real world, NFTs could be an efficient way to check titles and verify ownership history. Timestamped NFTs are a good way to track changes in property value. Smart contracts can be used to simplify and speed up transactions. It becomes possible to create decentralised home rental services with auto payments